
Bina Refinery, Bharat Petroleum

WHY DOES 'NET ZERO' MATTER?

Maharatna energy company, BPCL shows the way to help India comfortably meet its global commitment.

Torrential floods in Uttarakhand, a few years ago, resulted in floods and landslides resulting in a great loss of livelihood and lives. This year, as rains continued into the Kharif season, farmers across the country are staring at losses as standing crops have been damaged. "During the 2016 drought, there were no rains after sowing. We suffered losses. But in the last few years, we have suffered double losses due to the havoc caused by the rains during the harvest season." says Atmaram Pawar from Nanded. Farmers across the country have started fearing the non-seasonal rains more than the droughts. A food crisis is just around the corner.

"Climate change is not of our making," Hon. Prime Minister Narendra Modi said at the United Nations' 2015 climate change talks in Paris. "It is the result of global warming that came from the prosperity and progress of an industrial age powered by fossil fuel. But we in India face its consequences today. We see it in the risks of our farmers, the changes in weather patterns, and the intensity of natural disasters."

India is trying to reduce its carbon emissions by switching to solar power and other cleaner energy sources. Whether India succeeds in this energy renaissance depends on energy companies and the will of the people to shift to greener energy.

BPCL, a Maharatna Public Sector undertaking, is already progressing on a well chalked out plan in this direction. Arun Kumar Singh, Chairman & Managing Director, BPCL says, "India has embarked upon a path-breaking and ambitious journey of Rapid Decarbonisation with the announcement of a five-fold strategy - termed as the Panchamrita - at COP26 by our Honourable Prime Minister recently. BPCL, committed to nation-building for decades, is set to be at the forefront of this journey. As we continue to meet the rising energy needs of millions of our consumers and scale newer frontiers of growth, we are pleased to announce our roadmap to become a Net Zero Energy Company by 2040 in Scope I and Scope II emissions. The Trisutri of Green Hydrogen, Green Power and Green Innovations will drive our decarbonisation commitments".

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His company plans investments in the business of gas and clean fuel to get ready for a future where conventional fuels and zero-carbon mobility in electric vehicles (EVs) and hydrogen will co-exist. It is expanding its electric vehicle charging network with 7000 conventional retail outlets in short to medium term, upgrading to offer multiple fueling options like petrol, diesel, flexi-fuels, EV charging facility, CNG, and eventually hydrogen.

BPCL is also aggressively looking at the renewable fuel space, both as a solar and wind energy producer, allowing it to diversify and offset GHG emissions arising from fossil fuels. Renewable power can also help in enabling EVs and in the production of green hydrogen. They have collaborated with Bhabha Atomic Research Centre (BARC) to scale-up Alkaline Electrolyser technology for Green Hydrogen production.

The company has already been ranked India's top oil and gas company for its sustainability performance in the 2021 edition of the S&P Dow Jones Sustainability Indices (DJSI) Corporate Sustainability Assessment (CSA).

As other energy companies follow suit, India should comfortably deliver its global commitment.